

General Insurance Association Annual Report 2015

ON TARGET

MAKING THE MARK. MAKING A DIFFERENCE

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"WEATHERING THE CHALLENGING TIMES AHEAD"

GIA's achievements last year were made possible by the hard work, dedication and tireless efforts of our members and partners. We have emerged from a challenging year as economic and trade slowdown and other external headwinds affected some areas of our business. Still, we managed to grow our 2015 premiums, with our total gross premiums increasing by 2.6% to **S$3.6 BILLION** over the previous year. Our total net earned premiums, on the other hand, declined by 7% to S$2.4 billion, while our total underwriting profit fell by 17% to S$325 million.

Hull Insurance

16.7%

Increase

Hull Insurance posted the biggest year-on-year increase in gross premiums as it expanded by 16.7%, followed by Health Insurance, which overtook Fire Insurance to become the second largest business class in 2015 with more than 14% growth. Fire Insurance also fared well but at a slower pace of nearly 9%, and so did Personal Accident with a 4.6% increase in gross premiums.

Although still taking the biggest chunk of the business with S$1.1 billion, Motor Insurance saw its gross premiums decreased by about 4%. Likewise, Work Injury Compensation (WIC) and Cargo Insurance fell 3.2% and 11.5%, respectively, in their gross premiums.

S$1.1 billion

Motor Insurance

OUR 2015 INITIATIVES

Last year, we made strides in strengthening the leadership of our committees, introducing efficient systems, improving our claims management and rate setting, and reinforcing our capabilities through talent building and knowledge sharing.

The highlight of 2015 was our celebration of SG50, where Singapore's insurance industry came together to mark the Republic's 50th year of independence. GIA pooled resources with the Life Insurance Association of Singapore, the Singapore Reinsurers' Association as well as other insurance bodies to organise the SG50 Insurance Golf – Swing for Charity 2015, which saw more than 200 industry practitioners joining in the historic celebration. Thanks to our golfers and supporters, we raised more than S$600,000 for our seven nominated beneficiaries.

Last year, we revised the GIA Constitution which took effect from 1 February 2016 to ensure that we remain responsive to the needs of our industry. As part of this exercise, we increased the number of management committee members from eight to nine for two years of service. We have also lengthened the tenure of Office Bearers from one year to two years, with eligibility for reelection of up to three consecutive terms. (i.e. 6 years)

We restructured the association's key committees such that members of the GIA Management Committee (MC) now provide leadership to the four restructured committees: the Agents' Registration Board, Motor Committee, Work Injury Compensation (WIC) Committee and Technical Committee. One MC member now heads each committee with another serving as deputy, to ensure strategic guidance in the decision-makings and activities of the groups.

Our motor business, being the biggest segment of our industry, remained at the centre of our initiatives in 2015. We put in resources in the area of data and information systems with the aim of supporting and enhancing our underwriting practices and claims management.



The Motor Committee fine-tuned the Barometer of Liability Agreement (BOLA) Dispute Resolution Mechanism (DRM) to help speed up motor claims settlement, and increased the number of scenarios BOLA covers by determining geographical limits and reviewing processes involving police investigations. Likewise, the committee facilitated a simplified and cost-efficient framework for resolving BOLA disputes amongst members, resulting in more such disputes being resolved through adjudication.

>>> Our 2015 Initiatives

To help us better manage our motor portfolio, the Insurance Fraud Committee stepped up its efforts in detecting and preventing fraudulent cases by standardising the use of red flags in ferreting out suspicious claims. We have agreed on a set of red flags, which would make it easier for us to identify and look into questionable claims. There is more work we need to do though, particularly in moving into a computerised system to help us better track, store, and share information on suspicious and fraudulent claims. We will put in more resources into this to ensure that we have this system ready before the end of this year.

Following the amendments to the Work Injury Compensation Act (WICA), we issued guidance to members on the increase in WICA limits and a new feature that facilitates early return to work. We made our members particularly aware of the increases in compensation limits for workplace related injuries and claimable expenses facilitating an injured worker's return to work.

Through the WIC committee, we will continue to work toward introducing industry standards for the collection of wage information for annual WIC policies and setting up a database containing policy and claims information. Such a database will not only help our members address information gaps on the accident records and claims history of prospective clients, but will also guide them in pricing premiums more accurately.



BOOSTING PRACTITIONER CAPABILITIES

Our programme to boost the capabilities and business knowledge of our practitioners saw us carrying on with our educational seminars — key of which is our long running Maritime Knowledge Shipping Session. Thanks to our partner Singapore Maritime Foundation, marine insurance practitioners continue to have an opportunity to keep themselves up-to-date with developments and issues affecting the marine insurance and maritime business.

Meanwhile, our Fire Education Seminar and Property Knowledge Seminar Series continued to attract many participants as we diversified the areas these talks covered to keep them in sync with developments in these two segments. Similarly, the General Insurance (GI) Actuarial Knowledge Seminar, though a relatively new offering, had gained traction in attracting participants among our actuarial practitioners in the industry.

EDUCATING OUR CONSUMERS

As we sought to widen the reach of our consumer education programmes, we published the "General Insurance & U" education series on motor, fire and property insurance in ***The Sunday Times Invest.*** These advertisements highlighted what consumers should do in the event of a motor accident or the types of coverage they should look out for before purchasing a fire and home content insurance policy.

We are looking to further strengthen our consumer education programmes to reach more audiences as part of our effort to bring about greater awareness of the common types of general insurance. We will continue to highlight to the public how they can use general insurance to minimise their risks through traditional channels such as mass media as well as new platforms including online ones.

ENSURING FLOW OF FRESH TALENT

We continued to promote the attractiveness of a GI industry career to bright young people via our GIA Internship Programme (GIP). Into its 8th year in 2015, the GIA Internship Programme is one success story that has consistently delivered on its objective of inducting fresh talent to our industry. Last year, it successfully placed 27 interns with 17 participating companies from various sectors of the Singapore general insurance industry. Since the programme started, we have initiated 207 interns, with more than 40 interns having joined the general insurance industry as full-fledged employees as of January 2016.

Complementing the GIP is our Talent Outreach Project (TOP). In 2015, under the auspices of this project, we continued to stage career fairs at local universities to highlight the career opportunities offered by the industry.

STRENGTHENING OUR TIES

It was not all work for the industry. We also engaged in some play, while at the same time strengthening our ties with our partners and our staff. Our annual GIA Appreciation Night at The Wine Company@Sentosa Boardwalk was a gesture of our appreciation to the industry and our partner institutions for their support of the Association's various programmes. Our yearly General Insurance (GI) Day was similarly an occasion that put the focus on family, with 500 staff and their loved ones gathering to spend the day in a trip to the Lee Kong Chian Natural History Museum.



We are moving on from 2015 with higher standards, strengthened systems and improved capabilities. I extend my thanks to our GIA Management Committee, our various committees, our members and staff, and our partners including the Monetary Authority of Singapore, Land Transport Authority, Traffic Police, Ministry of Manpower, Singapore Maritime Foundation, Consumers Association of Singapore and Automobile Association of Singapore.

There are challenges ahead of us as we navigate through a period of uncertainty in the domestic and regional economies. But 2016 is a year to look forward to for GIA and the Singapore general insurance industry as we celebrate our 50th jubilee as an Association. We have begun planning for this much-awaited occasion, which will feature a singing contest for our practitioners who would like to showcase their vocal talents, the finals of which will culminate in a jubilee dinner singing competition. Our charity golf event, of course, is not to be missed.

We have more in store, so keep tabs on announcements from GIA as we work on making these events a success and 2016 another productive year for the industry.

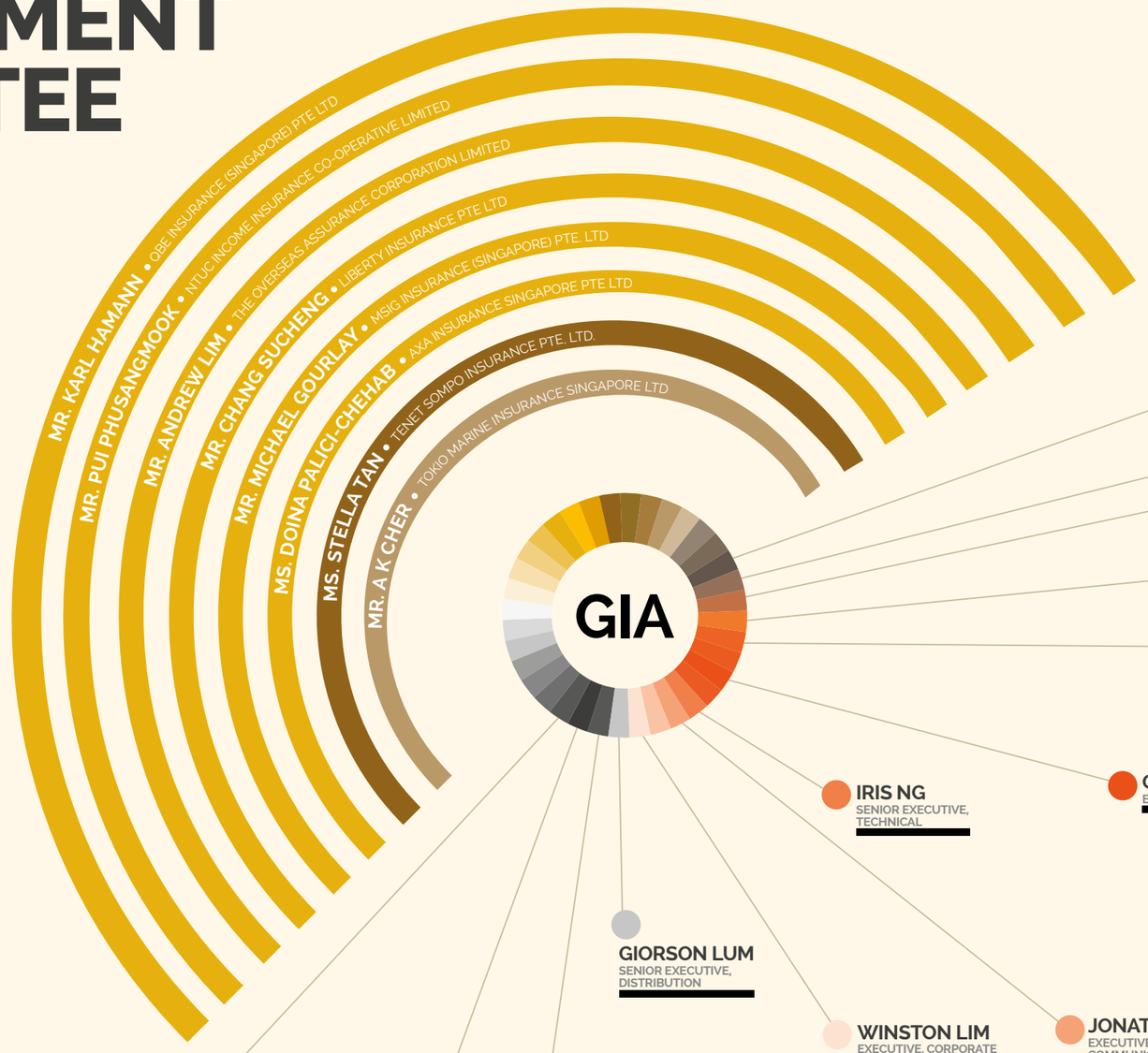
Thank you.



A.K. Cher
President

MANAGEMENT COMMITTEE

- MEMBERS
- VICE PRESIDENT
- PRESIDENT



DEREK TEO
CHIEF EXECUTIVE

MELVIN FUN
HEAD, FINANCE

CHOO WAI SAN
SENIOR MANAGER, AGENTS' REGISTRATION BOARD & CORPORATE SERVICES

JIMMY TAN
TECHNICAL DIRECTOR

SHARON CHEN
ASSISTANT MANAGER, TECHNICAL

CYNTHIA CHAN
EXECUTIVE, TECHNICAL

IRIS NG
SENIOR EXECUTIVE, TECHNICAL

GIORSON LUM
SENIOR EXECUTIVE, DISTRIBUTION

WINSTON LIM
EXECUTIVE, CORPORATE COMMUNICATIONS

JONATHAN OOI
EXECUTIVE, CORPORATE COMMUNICATIONS

HELEN LUM
ADMINISTRATOR, DISTRIBUTION

ROSALIND CHER
CUSTOMER SERVICE OFFICER

TAN YAN LIN
EXECUTIVE, FINANCE/ADMIN

SECRETARIAT GROUP

ACCIDENT AND HEALTH WORKGROUP

CHAIRMAN

Mr. Kelvin Lim
HL Assurance Pte. Ltd

DEPUTY CHAIRPERSON (UNTIL JAN 2016)

Ms. Christine Wee
Federal Insurance Company

MEMBERS

Ms. McWhinney Wai Lin
ACE Insurance Limited

Mr. Ignatius Chng
AIG Asia Pacific Insurance Pte. Ltd

Ms. Chan Ching Ching
Allied World Assurance Company, Ltd, Singapore Branch

Mr. Johann Simon
AXA Insurance Singapore Pte Ltd

Ms. Lena Tsia
Cigna Europe Insurance Co S.A. - N.V., Singapore Branch

Mr. Eric Tan
EQ Insurance Company Limited

Ms. Annie Chua
NTUC Income Insurance Co-operative Limited

Ms. Rosalind Phuan
QBE Insurance (Singapore) Pte Ltd

Ms. Lisa Leow
Zurich Insurance Company Ltd (Singapore Branch)

AGENTS' REGISTRATION BOARD

CHAIRPERSON

Ms. Stella Tan
Tenet Sompo Insurance Pte. Ltd

DEPUTY CHAIRMAN

Mr. Andrew Lim
The Overseas Assurance Corporation Limited

MEMBERS

Ms. Julia Baumann
AIG Asia Pacific Insurance Pte. Ltd

Ms. Doina Palici-Chehab
AXA Insurance Singapore Pte Ltd

Mr. Kelvin Lim
HL Assurance Pte. Ltd

Mr. Ronnie Yang
Liberty Insurance Pte Ltd

Mr. Peh Chee Keong
NTUC Income Insurance Co-operative Limited

BOLA ADJUDICATORS

Ms. Annie Chong
AIG Asia Pacific Insurance Pte. Ltd

Mr. Ghandian Krishnan
AIG Asia Pacific Insurance Pte. Ltd

Mr. Lincoln Yeo
AIG Asia Pacific Insurance Pte. Ltd

Mr. Albert Chua
Aviva Limited

Mr. Dominic Ho
AXA Insurance Singapore Pte Ltd

Ms. Valencia Lee
AXA Insurance Singapore Pte Ltd

Mr. Alfred Toh
China Taiping Insurance (Singapore) Pte. Ltd.

Ms. Chee So Chow
China Taiping Insurance (Singapore) Pte. Ltd.

Ms. Susan Teo
China Taiping Insurance (Singapore) Pte. Ltd.

Ms. Lim Wen Hwei
Direct Asia Insurance (Singapore) Pte Ltd

Ms. Tracy Tan
ECICS Limited

Mr. Charlie Neo
EQ Insurance Company Limited

Ms. Sally Tan
ERGO Insurance Pte. Ltd

Ms. Mary Aloysia Nelson
First Capital Insurance Ltd

Ms. Novin Siah
First Capital Insurance Ltd

Mr. Mekavathanan Sarangapani
India International Insurance Pte. Ltd

Mr. Mike Neo
India International Insurance Pte. Ltd

Ms. Puan Mui Hong
Liberty Insurance Pte. Ltd

Mr. Chew Beng Kee
Lonpac Insurance Berhad

Mr. Christopher Chionh
MSIG Insurance (Singapore) Pte. Ltd

Ms. Eng Huey Ni
MSIG Insurance (Singapore) Pte. Ltd

Mr. Jason Sim Poh Teck
MSIG Insurance (Singapore) Pte. Ltd

Mr. Sam Tan
MSIG Insurance (Singapore) Pte. Ltd

Mr. Eddie Loke
NTUC Income Insurance Co-operative Limited

Ms. Jenny Pe
NTUC Income Insurance Co-operative Limited

Mr. Alvin Tan
Tokio Marine Insurance Singapore Ltd

Mr. Jeffrey Tay
Tokio Marine Insurance Singapore Ltd

BOLA REVIEW WORKGROUP

MEMBERS

Ms. Annie Chong
AIG Asia Pacific Insurance Pte Ltd

Mr. Lincoln Yeo
AIG Asia Pacific Insurance Pte Ltd

Mr. Albert Chua
Aviva Ltd

Mr. John Mestas
AXA Insurance Singapore Pte Ltd

Mr. Low Yong Yeow
Direct Asia Insurance (Singapore) Pte Ltd

Mr. Charlie Neo
EQ Insurance Company Ltd

Ms. Puan Mui Hong
Liberty Insurance Pte Ltd

Mr. Christopher Chionh
MSIG Insurance (Singapore) Pte Ltd

Ms. Jenny Pe
NTUC Income Insurance Co-operative Limited

Ms. Fiona Gan
Tokio Marine Insurance Singapore Ltd

CODE OF PRACTICE

CHAIRMAN

Mr. Derek Low
Liberty Insurance Pte Ltd

MEMBERS

Mr. Ghandian Krishnan
AIG Asia Pacific Insurance Pte. Ltd

Mr. Alvino Kor
Aviva Limited

Ms. Daphne Koh
AXA Insurance Singapore Pte Ltd

Ms. Jenny Pe
NTUC Income Insurance
Co-operative Limited

Ms. Emmeline Tsai (Until 31 Dec 2015)
Tokio Marine Insurance Singapore Ltd

CONSTITUTION & STRUCTURAL REVIEW

CHAIRPERSON

Ms. Stella Tan
Tenet Sompo Insurance Pte. Ltd

MEMBERS

Ms. Doina Palici-Chehab
AXA Insurance Singapore Pte Ltd

Mr. Karl Hamann
QBE Insurance (Singapore) Pte Ltd

INSURANCE FRAUD

CHAIRMAN

Mr. Chang Sucheng
Liberty Insurance Pte Ltd

MEMBERS

Mr. Jayadas Kandiah
AIG Asia Pacific Insurance Pte. Ltd

Mr. Vincent Ho
AXA Insurance Singapore Pte Ltd

Mr. Mike Neo
India International Insurance Pte Ltd

Mr. Andy Foo
Liberty Insurance Pte Ltd

Mr. Miguel Piombo
Liberty Insurance Pte Ltd

Mr. Jason Sim Poh Teck
MSIG Insurance (Singapore) Pte. Ltd

Mr. Low Choo Mee
NTUC Income Insurance
Co-operative Limited

Mr. Jon Tay
Tokio Marine Insurance Singapore Ltd

MOTOR COMMITTEE

CONVENOR

Mr. Pui Phusangmook
NTUC Income Insurance
Co-operative Limited

DEPUTY CONVENOR

Mr. Chang Sucheng
Liberty Insurance Pte Ltd

MEMBERS

Mr. Ghandian Krishnan
AIG Asia Pacific Insurance Pte. Ltd

Ms. Lily Chua
Allied World Assurance
Company, Ltd, Singapore Branch

Ms. Valencia Lee
AXA Insurance Singapore Pte Ltd

Mr. Charlie Neo
EQ Insurance Company Limited

Mr. Mekavathanan Sarangapani
India International Insurance Pte Ltd

Mr. Sam Tan
MSIG Insurance (Singapore) Pte. Ltd

Ms. Jenny Pe
NTUC Income Insurance
Co-operative Limited

Mr. Alvin Tan
Tokio Marine Insurance
Singapore Ltd

MOTOR THEMATIC WORKGROUP

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India International Insurance Pte Ltd

MEMBERS

Mr. Jegaprakash Yogarajah
AIG Asia Pacific Insurance Pte Ltd

Ms. Lily Chua
Allied World Assurance Company, Ltd, Singapore Branch

Mr. Dominic Ho
AXA Insurance Singapore Pte Ltd

Ms. Puan Mui Hong
Liberty Insurance Pte Ltd

Ms. Chew Shin Ling
Lonpac Insurance Bhd

Mr. Christopher Chionh
MSIG Insurance (Singapore) Pte Ltd

Mr. Thio Tse Kiat
NTUC Income Insurance Co-operative Limited

Mr. Leonard Ang
QBE Insurance (Singapore) Pte Ltd

Mr. Alvin Tan
Tokio Marine Insurance Singapore Ltd

PREMIUM PAYMENT FRAMEWORK

GIA

Mr. Mack Eng - Chairman (until 24 Nov 2015)
ACE Insurance Limited

Ms. Lisa Marbon
AXA Insurance Singapore Pte Ltd

Mr. Chan Tar Seng
MSIG Insurance (Singapore) Pte. Ltd

SINGAPORE INSURANCE BROKERS' ASSOCIATION

Ms. Chua Wan Ching
AON Singapore Pte Ltd

Mr. Michael Chew
AVA Insurance Brokers Pte Ltd

Mr. George Thomas
Newstate Stenhouse (S) Pte. Ltd

MONETARY AUTHORITY OF SINGAPORE

Mr. Lim Hong Jie
Monetary Authority of Singapore

Mr. Ng Cheng Wei
Monetary Authority of Singapore

REINSURANCE CONTRACT CERTAINTY

CHAIRMAN (CO-CHAIRMAN)

Mr. Soon Gud Voon
NTUC Income Insurance Co-operative Limited

Mr. Nick Garrity
Swiss Reinsurance Company Ltd

MEMBERS

Mr. Rubhan Krishnaswamy
AIG Asia Pacific Insurance Pte. Ltd

Ms. Jaya.SC.Taylor
Allianz Global Corporate & Specialty SE, Singapore Branch

Mr. Thomas Lim
AXA Insurance Singapore Pte Ltd

Mr. Ramachandran Vaidyanathan
First Capital Insurance Ltd

Ms. Chong Ai Mei
Great American Insurance Company, Singapore Branch

Ms. Shirley Lim Seow Eng
India International Insurance Pte Ltd

Ms. Valerie Lee
Tokio Marine Insurance Singapore Ltd

Mr. Daryl Gomez
XL Insurance Company SE Singapore Branch

SPECIAL RISKS POOL (SRP)

CHAIRMAN

Mr. A K Cher
Tokio Marine Insurance Singapore Ltd

MEMBERS

Mr. Charlie Neo
EQ Insurance Company Limited

Mr. Sam Tan
MSIG Insurance (Singapore) Pte. Ltd

Ms. Jenny Pe
NTUC Income Insurance Co-operative Limited

Mr. Pui Phusangmook
NTUC Income Insurance Co-operative Limited

Ms. Stella Tan
Tenet Sompo Insurance Pte. Ltd

Mr. Andrew Lim
The Overseas Assurance Corporation Limited

POOL MANAGER

Mr. Chan Kheng Hua
India International Insurance Pte Ltd

TAX WORKGROUP

CHAIRMAN

Mr. Brendan Egan
AIG Asia Pacific Insurance Pte. Ltd

MEMBERS

Ms. Madeline Kong
Allianz Global Corporate & Specialty SE, Singapore Branch

Ms. Daphne Lam
AXA Insurance Singapore Pte Ltd

Ms. Vanessa Teo
Great American Insurance Company, Singapore Branch

Mr. Jason Tan
Liberty Insurance Pte Ltd

Mr. Howard Goh
QBE Insurance (Singapore) Pte Ltd

Mr. Adrian Chua
Tenet Sompo Insurance Pte. Ltd

Ms. Tan Cheok Sin
Tokio Marine Insurance Singapore Ltd

TECHNICAL COMMITTEE

CONVENOR

Mr. Karl Hamann
QBE Insurance (Singapore) Pte Ltd

DEPUTY CONVENOR

Ms. Doina Palici-Chehab
AXA Insurance Singapore Pte Ltd

MEMBERS

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Atrium Underwriting Group Limited

Mr. Choong Wing King
AXA Insurance Singapore Pte Ltd

Ms. Lee Ju-Ann
Federal Insurance Company

Mr. Richard Kuek
Gurbani & Co LLC

Mr. Jonathan Ranger
Munich Re Syndicate Singapore Pte Ltd

Ms. Shirley Ow
QBE Insurance (Singapore) Pte Ltd

Mr. Lim Keng Hong
The Overseas Assurance Corporation Limited

Ms. Karen Chin
Zurich Insurance Company Ltd (Singapore Branch)

TRADE CREDIT & POLITICAL RISK

CHAIRMAN

Mr. Mark Houghton
XL Insurance Company SE Singapore Branch

DEPUTY CHAIRMAN

Mr. Stephen Capon
ACE Insurance Limited

MEMBERS

Ms. Melissa Chai
AIG Asia Pacific Insurance Pte. Ltd

Mr. Andrew Loh
Atradius Credit Insurance N.V

Mr. Michael Lum
Beazley Pte Limited

Ms. Liliz Chen
Canopius Asia Pte Ltd

Mr. Martin Phelan
Catlin Singapore Pte Limited

Mr. Alastair Townsend-Rose
Chaucer Singapore Pte Ltd

Mr. Marcus Hall
Chaucer Singapore Pte Ltd

Mr. Fabien Conderanne
Coface Singapore

Mr. Nick Wong
EQ Insurance Company Limited

Mr. Ronald Cheng
EQ Insurance Company Limited

Mr. Thomas Laportemany
Eulerhermes Singapore

Mr. Andrew Beechey
Liberty International Underwriters Pte Limited

Mr. Abhishek Chhajer
Markel International Singapore Pte Ltd

Ms. Jaime Taylor
Talbot Risk Services Pte Ltd

Ms. Olivia Wright
Talbot Risk Services Pte Ltd

Mr. Dennis Eucogco
Zurich Insurance Company Limited

Mr. Tim Warren
Zurich Insurance Company Ltd

WORK INJURY COMPENSATION

CONVENOR

Mr. Michael Gourlay
MSIG Insurance (Singapore) Pte. Ltd

DEPUTY CONVENOR

Ms. Doina Palici-Chehab
AXA Insurance Singapore Pte Ltd

MEMBERS

Ms. Daphne Boon
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Mr. Ng Kok Hee
Allied World Assurance Company, Ltd, Singapore Branch

Mr. P K Leong
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Ms. Edna Ngo
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AXA Insurance Singapore Pte Ltd
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www.ergo.com.sg

Etiqa Insurance Pte. Ltd.
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Federal Insurance Company
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China Square Central
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First Capital Insurance Ltd
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ASSOCIATE MEMBER

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FORMER PRESIDENTS

1966 — Tan Hoay Gie — 1967

1968 — 1968 A.G. Mackenzie

1969 — 1969 A.D. Moodie

1970 — 1970 Maurice C. Lee

1971 — 1971 Tan Hoay Gie

1972 — 1972 A.T. Shimpi

1973 — 1975 Chew Loy Kiat

1976 — 1977 A.T. Shimpi

1978 — 1979 Tan Hoay Gie

1980 — 1981 Hwang Soo Jin

1982 — 1983 Koh Bee Chye

1984 — 1985 Teo Kwang Whee

1986 — 1987 Hwang Soo Jin

1988 — 1989 Koh Bee Chye

1990 — 1991 Peter Lee Bong Soo

1992 — 1993 Peter Yap Kim Kee

1994 — 1995 David Chan Mun Wai

1996 — 1997 Loo Sun Mun

1998 — 1999 Albert Koh

2000 — 2000 Seow Nee Shek

2001 — 2002 Law Song Keng

2003 — 2004 Terence Tan

2005 — 2012 Derek Teo

2013 — A K Cher — 2016

FORMER VICE PRESIDENTS

1966 — A.E. Sheperd — 1967

1967 — 1967 M.J.S. Newman

1968 — 1968 Tan Eng Heng

1969 — 1969 Tan Hoay Gie

1970 — 1970 D.M. Rae

1970 — 1970 J.A. Gilmour

1971 — 1971 J. Pocock

1972 — 1974 D.J. Collins-Taylor

1975 — 1976 R.E. Hughes

1977 — 1977 D.E. Parry

1978 — 1979 P.J. Rackley

1980 — 1981 G.L. Ellis

1982 — 1982 D.S. Wyber

1983 — 1983 R.G. Dougal

1983 — 1983 N.F. Seddon

1984 — 1986 K.F. Jones

1984 — 1986 S.R. Moffatt

1987 — 1987 Paul Frankland

1988 — 1991 Loo Sun Mun

1992 — 1992 W.J. Perrott

1993 — 1993 David Chan Mun Wai

1994 — 1995 Margaret Yang

1996 — 2000 David Chan Mun Wai

2001 — 2001 Peter Yap Kim Kee

2002 — 2002 Neil Emery

2003 — 2005 Stella Tan

2006 — 2011 Michael Goodwin

2012 — 2012 A.K. Cher

2013 — Stella Tan — 2016



BUSINESS IN REVIEW

The Singapore general insurance industry posted mixed 2015 results as some segments of its business were affected by a slowdown in the economy and from external headwinds. Total gross premiums continued to grow by

2.6% to S$3.6 billion

in 2015, surpassing the 1.1% increase registered in 2014, while total net earned premiums declined by

7% to S$2.4 billion

from the previous year. Total underwriting profit fell by 17% year-on-year to S$325 million.

Hull Insurance delivered the best performance in gross premiums as it grew by 16.7% to S$180.4 million, though it remained the second smallest segment among the major classes of business.

Following it was Health Insurance, which overtook Fire Insurance to become the second largest business segment in 2015 with more than 14% growth to S$435.3 million. Fire Insurance also fared well but at a slower pace of nearly 9% to post S$396.6 million in gross premiums, and so did Personal Accident with a 4.6% increase to S$345.4 million.

On the other hand, Motor's gross premiums went down by about 4% from a year ago, but it still took the lion's share of the business with S$1.1 billion. Work Injury Compensation (WIC) and Cargo Insurance also saw their gross premiums slide by 3.2% to S$383.5 million and 11.5% to S$84.5 million, respectively.

Hull and Health Insurance coupled their strong premium results with an even more outstanding performance in their underwriting profits. Hull posted a 117.7% year-on-year growth, while Health took home a 109.1% increase in underwriting profit. WIC came in third with 92% growth, followed by Cargo with 34.3%.

Fire delivered the weakest underwriting result with its profit falling by more than 50%. Similarly, Personal Accident reported a 41.7% fall in underwriting profit, and so did Motor with a 20% decline.

Looking at the niche business classes, collectively they posted a year-on-year increase of 6.4% in gross premiums to S$651.8 million. Their total underwriting profit went down by 25.6% to S$91.8 million, however, with Credit Insurance making a loss of S$2.1 million.

MOTOR

Motor Insurance continued to have the biggest slice of the general insurance pie with a 32% share despite a 4% decrease in gross premiums to S$1.1 billion. This decline can be attributed to the tight competition in this segment, as evident in the falling average motor premium. The 2015 average motor premium went down by almost 3% from S$1,227 the preceding year—higher than the almost 2% decrease recorded in 2014.

Its underwriting profit was also affected, falling by 20% from S$150 million the previous year and a turnaround from its 153% year-on-year increase in 2014.

HEALTH INSURANCE

Health Insurance benefited from a renewed emphasis on and interest in having sufficient health insurance coverage as the Singapore government launched a universal health insurance scheme. It had crossed the S$400-million mark in gross premiums with a 14% year-on-year increase to S$435.3 million, making it the second largest business segment in 2015.

From a loss of S$7 million in 2014, Health Insurance made a strong turnaround to make $628,000 in underwriting profit, an impressive year-on-year expansion of 109.1%.

FIRE

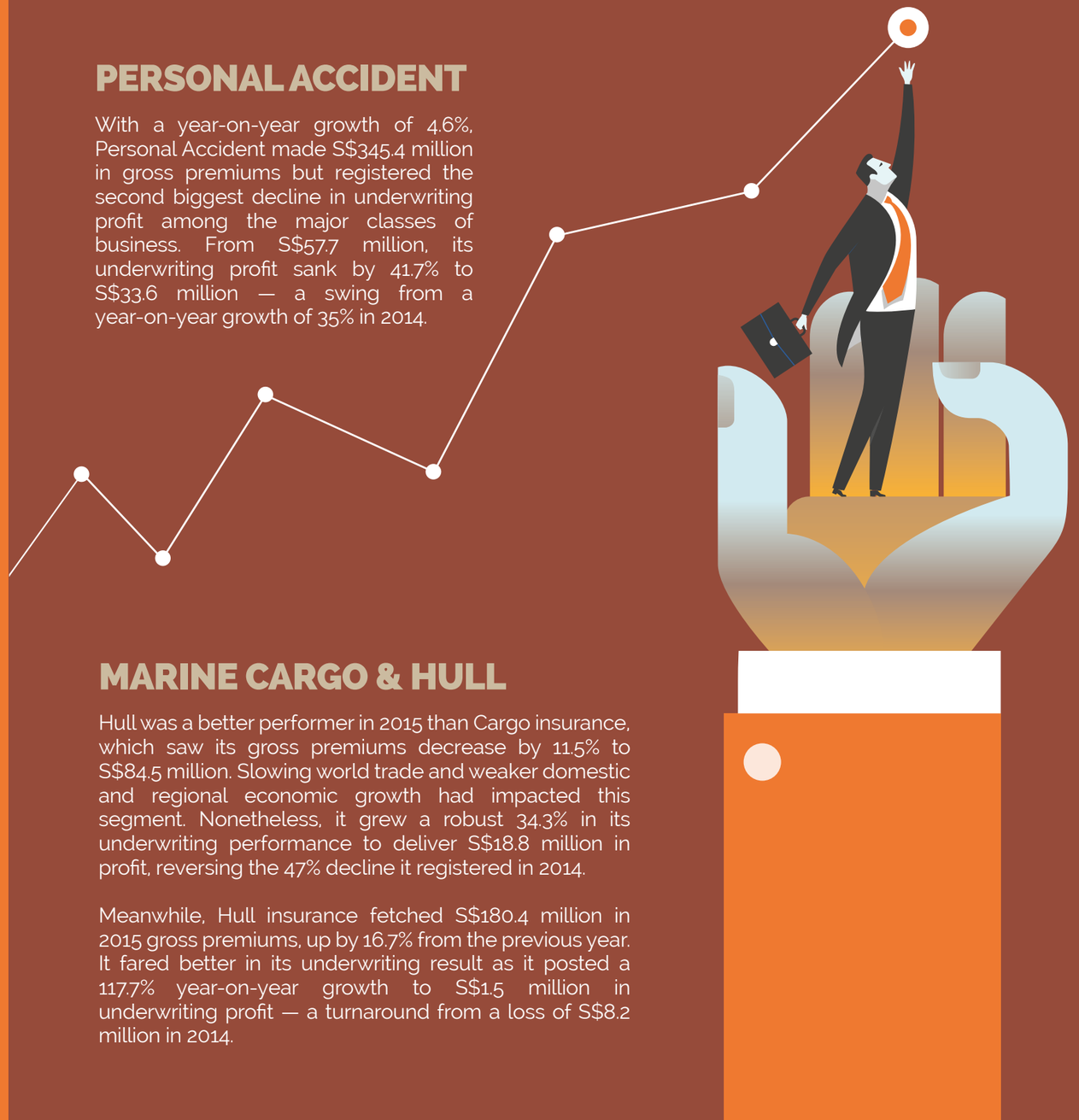
Fire Insurance delivered S$396.6 million in gross premiums to settle at the third spot among the major classes of business, growing by nearly 9% from the previous year. It posted the weakest performance in underwriting result, though. Its profit dove by more than 50% to S$21 million, breaking its two consecutive years of robust underwriting growth in 2013 and 2014.

WIC

From being the second largest class of business in 2014, WIC came in fourth in its share of 2015 gross premiums with S$383.5 million, down by 3.2% from the previous year. Although lower than the remarkable 555% growth it posted in 2014, the segment still made a robust 92% increase in underwriting profit in 2015, delivering S$37.6 million in profit. This marked the second consecutive year of its solid underwriting result after posting a decline of more than 40% in 2013.

PERSONAL ACCIDENT

With a year-on-year growth of 4.6%, Personal Accident made S$345.4 million in gross premiums but registered the second biggest decline in underwriting profit among the major classes of business. From S$57.7 million, its underwriting profit sank by 41.7% to S$33.6 million — a swing from a year-on-year growth of 35% in 2014.



MARINE CARGO & HULL

Hull was a better performer in 2015 than Cargo insurance, which saw its gross premiums decrease by 11.5% to S$84.5 million. Slowing world trade and weaker domestic and regional economic growth had impacted this segment. Nonetheless, it grew a robust 34.3% in its underwriting performance to deliver S$18.8 million in profit, reversing the 47% decline it registered in 2014.

Meanwhile, Hull insurance fetched S$180.4 million in 2015 gross premiums, up by 16.7% from the previous year. It fared better in its underwriting result as it posted a 117.7% year-on-year growth to S$1.5 million in underwriting profit — a turnaround from a loss of S$8.2 million in 2014.

PUBLIC LIABILITY

The biggest segment among niche areas of business, Public Liability reported a decrease of 5.5% in its premium result, delivering S$127.5 million in gross premiums. It also suffered a year-on-year fall of 28.5% to S$24.8 million in its underwriting profit following a 33% decline the previous year.

BONDS

Bonds dropped from the second to the third biggest niche segment of business by gross premiums in 2015 as it grew only moderately by 4.3%, making S$121.8 million in gross premiums. It ended the year with an underwriting profit of S$20.7 million, an increase of 20.6% over the previous year.

PROFESSIONAL INDEMNITY

The segment continued on a positive growth track in 2015 with S$105.1 million in gross premiums, up year-on-year by 11%. Its underwriting result was stable as well, rising by 10.7% to S$22.04 million. This was much slower, though, than its 2014 year-on-year increase of 125%.

ENGINEERING/CAR/EAR

Engineering/CAR/EAR grew by 24% to S$125.6 million in gross premiums to become the second biggest business class among the specialist segments. On the other hand, its underwriting result fell by 75.7% to post S$6.04 million in profit, the second largest decline of all classes of business. This was a reversal of its performance in 2014, when its profit shot up by 168% over the previous year.



CREDIT INSURANCE

Growing by 21.6% over the previous year, Credit Insurance delivered S$62.3 million in gross premiums, the second biggest increase among the niche classes of business. However, it made a loss of S$2.1 million as its underwriting result fell by 130%, making 2015 the third consecutive year it made an underwriting loss.

INCURRED LOSS RATIOS

After six consecutive years of trimming its incurred loss ratio, the general insurance industry recorded an uptick of one percentage point in its loss ratio to 49.4% in 2015. Nonetheless, this was still lower than the 53.2% loss ratio registered in 2013, or the 53.9% seen in 2012.

Fire insurance posted the biggest jump in incurred loss ratio at 6.1 percentage points to 31.1%, followed by Personal Accident with a 4.8-percentage point increase to 33.9%. Both segments recorded declines in loss ratio the previous year. After making the biggest cut in 2014 by 9.5 percentage points, Motor insurance saw its loss ratio climb by 2.1 percentage points to 56% in 2015.

Hull insurance made the biggest cut in its loss ratio among the major classes of business, bringing it down by 23.1 percentage points, followed by Cargo insurance with a 7.9-percentage point decrease. Decreasing by 4.5 percentage points, WIC's loss ratio settled at 57.3%, while that of Health insurance stood at 65.8%, down by 0.4 percentage point.

Among the niche classes of business, Professional Indemnity and Bonds witnessed their incurred loss ratios go down by 17.8 and 4.8 percentage points to 9.8% and 26.5%, respectively. The rest all posted increases in their loss ratios, with Engineering/CAR/EAR recording the biggest jump at 34 percentage points to 37.1%.

CALENDAR OF EVENTS

JAN

21

- Maritime Excursion to Singapore Maritime Officers' Union Maritime Institute

MAR

16 · Maritime Knowledge Session 30 on The Maritime CAT Model

19 · Media Briefing on Industry Results

25 · Annual General Meeting

27 · Budget 2015 Briefing

MAY

11-15 · GIA Internship Program (GIP) Pre Internship Training

12 · GIA- Lloyds Talk on Singapore: Working Together for a Prosperous Future

13 · GIA Chief Executive Officer Townhall Meeting

15 · GIA Internship Program (GIP) Cocktail Party

JUN/JUL

15-16 · Council of Bureaux (COB) Workgroup Meeting in Bangkok

15 · SG50 Charity Golf

31 · GIA Fire Seminar on "Dealing with Complex Fire Claims"

AUG

16-17 · Annual Liaison Meeting between Brunei Insurance and Takaful Association (BITA) /Persatuan Insurans Am Malaysia (PIAM)/ General Insurance Association of Singapore (GIA) in Brunei

21 · Maritime Excursion to Port of Singapore Authority

27 · Marine Networking Night (5th session)

SEP/OCT

3 · Property Seminar on "The Challenges in Construction Insurance"

5 · Media Orientation on General Insurance by GIA

8-10 · 28th East Asian Insurance Congress

17 · GIA Family Day In celebration of General Insurance Day 2015

27-29 · 41th Asean Insurance Council (AIC) and 18th Asean Insurance Regulators' Meeting (AIRM) Meeting

NOV

17 · Special General Meeting on Constitution and Budget 2016

26 · Maritime Knowledge Session 31 on "Political Risk in the Region"

DEC

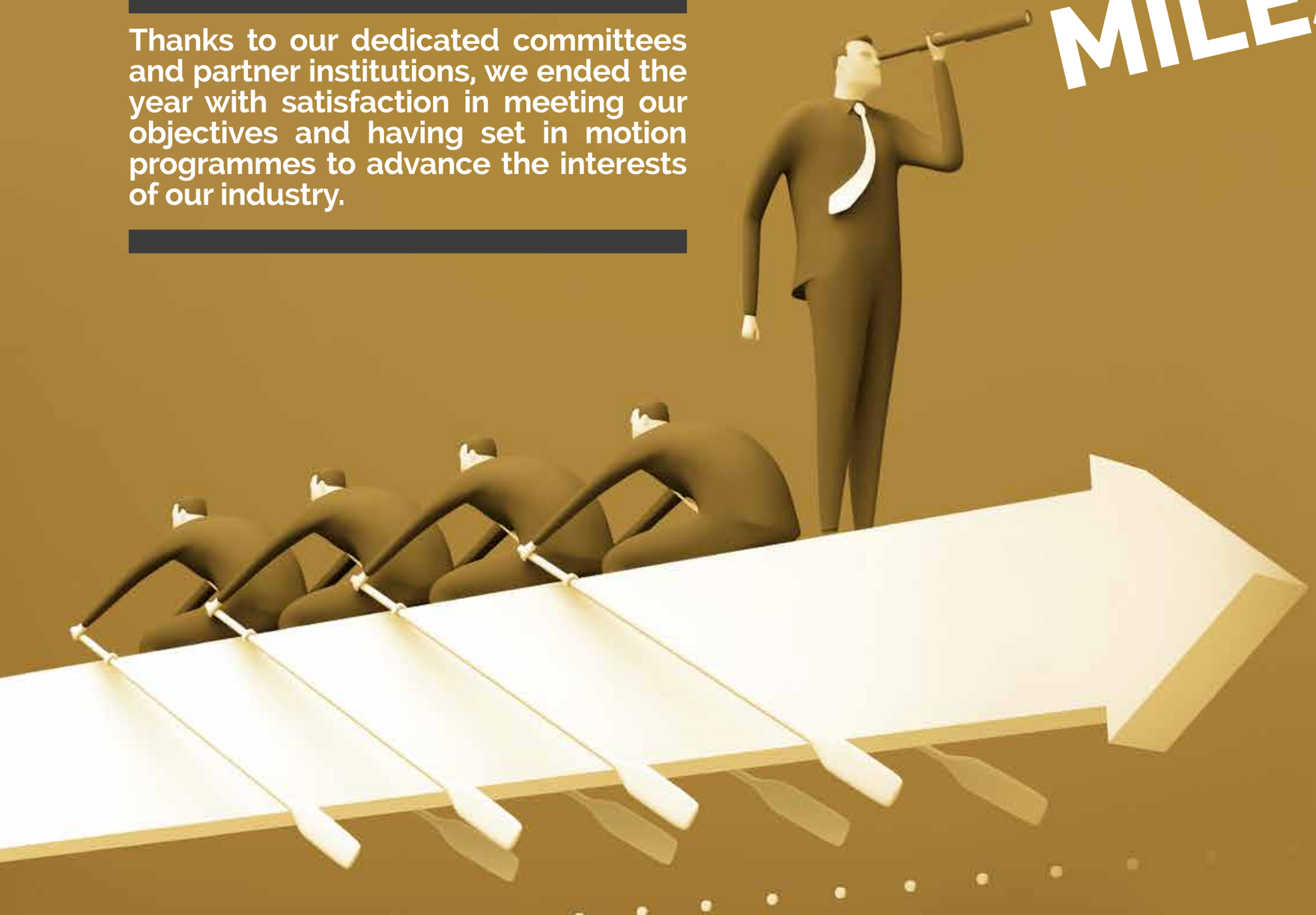
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- GIA Appreciation Night

INDUSTRY INITIATIVES & MILESTONES

2015 saw several significant accomplishments within the Singapore general insurance industry. Our members worked hard to further our accomplishments achieved in 2014 and to provide our new initiatives with a robust foundation and the necessary mechanisms to meet their outlined goals.

Thanks to our dedicated committees and partner institutions, we ended the year with satisfaction in meeting our objectives and having set in motion programmes to advance the interests of our industry.



PROVIDING LEADERSHIP TO COMMITTEES

Among our accomplishments in 2015 was the revision of the GIA Constitution - which was to ensure that it remains responsive to the needs of the general insurance industry. As part of this exercise, we increased the number of management committee members from eight to nine*. We have also restructured the Association's key committees. Under this arrangement, members of the GIA Management Committee would provide leadership to the four restructured committees, namely the Agents' Registration Board, Motor Committee, Work Injury Compensation Committee and Technical Committee. One Management Committee member would head each committee with another serving as deputy to ensure strategic guidance in the decision-making and activities of the group.

The renamed Work Injury Compensation Committee now focuses on work injury related issues. A newly created group, the Technical Committee, subsumes the Marine and Property sub-committees. Under this committee, various workgroups are formed periodically to address industry operational issues and impending regulatory changes affecting specific segments of the business. Workgroups that were formed over the past year include Political Risks and Trade Credit Insurance Workgroup, Accident and Health Workgroup, GIA Contract Certainty Workgroup, Tax Workgroup and Product Highlight Sheet Workgroup.

*The amendment exercise also included lengthening the tenure of Office Bearers from one year to two years, with reelection eligibility for up to three consecutive terms. All these changes took effect on 1 February 2016.

MOTOR COMMITTEE

Last year, the Motor Committee focused on various initiatives aimed at enhancing claims handling procedures, particularly in the area of data and information systems. It held three training sessions to bring users up to date on the GIA Records Management Centre system and help address familiarity issues due to staff movement, change of roles within the company and system updates. Particular focus was given to the Accident Reporting module and Barometer of Liability Agreement (BOLA) Centralised Online System.

The committee put in place enhancements to the BOLA Dispute Resolution Mechanism (DRM) to help speed up motor claims settlement. It increased the number of scenarios BOLA covers by determining geographical limits and reviewing processes involving police investigation. For example, it looked at whether BOLA applies if a motor accident happened in Malaysia, and clarified what "police action" meant in a motor accident claim under the system.

The committee also worked on BOLA adjudication to facilitate a simplified and cost-efficient framework in resolving BOLA disputes amongst members. By year end, more than 107 disputes had been resolved through 10 adjudication sessions. The committee also implemented a GIRO scheme for payment of DRM fees for manual cases, and has started imposing administrative fees for cases withdrawn from adjudication to discourage frivolous escalation of cases.

On a different matter, the committee engaged the State Courts to discuss the review of Non Injury Motor Accident (NIMA) and Personal Injury Practice Directions and Protocols. Members' interests on key issues were brought to their attention such as benchmark rates for costs of rental and loss of use, whether there is a need to amend these rates, as well as the appointment of a motor surveyor as a single expert. Proposed revisions to benchmark rates for costs of rental and loss of use, as well as a set of criteria for registering surveyors approved by GIA were submitted to the State Courts.

INSURANCE FRAUD COMMITTEE

Given the gravity of the issue on insurance fraud, the Insurance Fraud Committee stepped up its efforts in detecting and preventing fraudulent cases by raising the matter with the Commercial Affairs Department. It also started collating claims records involving Malaysian vehicles for accidents at carparks to enable the industry to detect fraudulent patterns related to such cases.

The committee also standardised the use of red flags in detecting suspicious claims into a more manageable and agreed set of red flags. As there is a need to move from a manual to a computerised system to help the industry better track, store and share information on suspicious and fraudulent claims, the Fraud Committee called for tenders to build a system for the creation of a database. To help reduce members' expenses for the implementation of fraud detection solutions, the committee also explored potential funding from the Infocomm Development Authority of Singapore.



WORK INJURY COMPENSATION COMMITTEE

In light of the recent Work Injury Compensation Act (WICA) legislative amendments, the committee issued guidance to members on the increase in WICA limits, and on a new feature that facilitates early return to work. Through this, member insurers gained awareness of the increases in compensation limits for workplace related injuries as well as claimable expenses facilitating an injured worker's return to work.

The committee also continued to work toward introducing industry standards for the collection of wage information for annual WIC policies in order to ensure consistency. Upon the Singapore Insurance Brokers' Association's agreement on this initiative in a meeting in September 2015, the proposal and wages declaration form was revised and circulated to members.

Setting up a WIC database containing policy and claims information was also at the centre of the committee's efforts in 2015. Such a database will help members address information gaps on the accident records and claims history of prospective clients, and will assist insurers in pricing premiums more accurately. The committee will go ahead with the implementation of the database once industry consensus is obtained.

AGENTS' REGISTRATION BOARD

The Agents' Registration Board (ARB) has taken a more proactive stance since the revision of the General Insurance Agents Registration Regulations (GIARR) effective January 2015.

With its expanded role in conducting ad-hoc audits on agents, the audit exercise aims to assist the ARB and insurers to verify agents' compliance with the mandatory requirements of the Insurance Act (Cap 142), the MAS Notice 211 and the GIARR.

It has audited three agents covering both operational and financial aspects of their agency business in 2015. While the exercise was a discovery process for the ARB, moving forward, gaps and weaknesses will be identified and measures for improvements within the ARB's powers will be proposed. ARB will also gradually increase the number of agents it audits with growing familiarity with the audit process.

TECHNICAL COMMITTEE

To keep members informed of large losses in the marine and property sector for underwriting purposes, the Technical Committee worked on collating large Marine Cargo and Property Damage & Business Interruption (PDBI) losses. The collated reports for the first three quarters of 2015 have been sent to the members that had submitted returns.



GIVING BACK AT SG50

In a much-awaited celebration, Singapore's insurance industry came together to celebrate the Republic's 50th year of independence. Together with the Life Insurance Association of Singapore and the Singapore Reinsurers' Association as well as other insurance bodies, GIA organised the SG50 Insurance Golf – Swing for Charity 2015, which saw more than 200 industry practitioners joining in the historic celebration.

The event raised more than S$600,000 for the seven nominated beneficiaries, making it all the more memorable. The Children's Cancer Foundation, National Kidney Foundation, Pertapis Education and Welfare Centre, Singapore Buddhist Free Clinic, Singapore Heart Foundation, St John's Home for Elderly Persons and Straits Times School Pocket Money Fund all benefited from the amount raised.

A dinner attended by over 300 guests and graced by Minister for Education, Mr Heng Swee Keat, capped the jovial and meaningful occasion.

STRENGTHENED CONSUMER EDUCATION

In GIA's quest to widen the reach of its consumer education programme, it published the "General Insurance & U" (GI&U) education series on motor, fire and property insurance in ***The Sunday Times*** Invest. These advertisements were aimed at educating consumers on what they should do in the event of a motor accident or the types of coverage they should look out for before purchasing a fire and home content insurance policy.

GIA looks to further strengthen its consumer education to reach a wider and more diverse audience on the common types of general insurance and how they can use them to minimise and manage risks.

In addition to the use of traditional media for consumer education, GIA is also increasingly leveraging on online platforms, starting with the GIA website. In November 2015, it launched a microsite to provide easy access to customer-friendly information on motor insurance.

MARKING GIP'S 8TH YEAR

Marking its 8th year in 2015, the GIA Internship Programme (GIP) successfully placed 27 interns with 17 participating companies from various sectors of the Singapore general insurance industry. This batch of interns completed their 10-week internship programme that commenced in May 2015.

Since it started in 2008, the GIP now counts 207 interns as participants in its comprehensive programme. As of January 2016, more than 40 interns have joined the general insurance industry as full-fledged employees, a testament to the GIP's effectiveness in creating pathways for young talents to establish rewarding careers in the industry.

The success of the GIP has been duplicated in the Talent Outreach Project, which GIA has been carrying out every year to help boost the industry's profile and to highlight career opportunities in the industry.

In 2015, GIA participated in career fairs at the National University of Singapore, Nanyang Technological University and Singapore Management University to raise students' awareness of the general insurance industry and to orientate them on the career options available to them in the industry. The career fairs saw ex-GIP interns sharing their GIP experiences with their schoolmates and encouraging them to sign up for the programme.

STRENGTHENING INDUSTRY KNOWLEDGE THROUGH COLLABORATION

One of the hallmarks of GIA's programmes is to foster industry capabilities and its educational seminars continue to offer general insurance practitioners opportunities to develop and strengthen their industry knowledge.

The Singapore Maritime Foundation (SMF), one of GIA's most steadfast partners in knowledge sharing, once again partnered with GIA to organise two seminars under the flagship Maritime Knowledge Shipping Session. Titled "The Maritime CAT Model" and "Political Risk in the Region", the seminars delved into timely maritime issues for both marine insurance and maritime professionals. The seminars covered topics such as modeling and managing marine risks in conjunction with property exposure and catastrophe risk management for marine risks.

The 5th annual Fire Education Seminar highlighted the process on how to deal with complex fire claims - an event which drew a crowd of 100 professionals. Attendees had a rare opportunity to listen to three experts in their field: a loss adjuster, a fire investigator and a legal professional.

Meanwhile, as part of the Property Knowledge Seminar Series, a timely seminar on the challenges of construction insurance was held. About 130 professionals learned about niche areas such as Contractors' All Risk Insurance and Performance Bond, and had the opportunity to ask expert presenters on issues concerning these areas.

In addition, the GI Actuarial Knowledge Seminar, a new offering to GIA's knowledge seminars, had its fourth session in March 2015 with the support of the Singapore Actuarial Society. This session centred on catastrophe reinsurance and capital optimisation, with experienced actuaries highlighting the types of reinsurance and coverage that may help companies optimise their capital, as well as the natural catastrophes in Asia that have made an impact on the offshore industry due to substantial financial losses.



GIA and the Association of Banks in Singapore organised a talk on Cargo Insurance – Standard and Non-Standard Clauses. The objective of this workshop was to actively link the general insurance industry to other sectors of the Singapore economy. A GIA representative spoke to an audience of mainly banking professionals on the basics of cargo insurance, commonly used cargo insurance covers, differences in institute cargo clauses over the years, examples of trade and non-institute clauses, as well as the Uniform Customs and Practice (UCP) 600.

In another marine- and maritime related event, GIA along with the Maritime and Port Authority of Singapore, the Singapore Maritime Foundation and the Singapore Shipping Association supported the International Bunker Industry Association's Bunker Forum in November 2015. Talks were held to educate participants from the maritime and marine insurance sectors on fuel quality trends, distillates and new fuel challenges, maximisation of residual fuels value, and the achievement of higher fuel burn efficiency through the use of new methods in the processing of fuel by tapping recent technologies.

FORGING STRONG TIES WITH NEIGHBOURING MARKETS

The Brunei Insurance and Takaful Association (BITA) hosted the 2015 gathering of the annual liaison meeting of the general insurance associations of Singapore, Malaysia and Brunei. The three associations shared with one another developments and business performance in their markets, as well as explored new ways of leveraging one another's industry best practices, particularly in the area of motor insurance.

With the ASEAN region becoming a single economic community in end 2015, the Singapore general insurance industry lent its presence and support to the 1st Council of Bureau Working Committee meeting held in June 2015. It also participated in the 16th ASEAN Council of Bureau, the 41st ASEAN Insurance Council, and the Joint Plenary Meeting between the Industry Associations and Regulators — all held in October 2015 in Phnom Penh, Cambodia. Among the key areas discussed was the follow-up on the recommendations presented by the ASEAN insurance industries and submitted to the ASEAN insurance regulators at the 2014 meeting in Brunei Darussalam.



BOOSTING INDUSTRY CAMARADERIE

The annual General Insurance (GI) Day served not only as an occasion to commemorate the role and importance of general insurance, but also served as an opportunity for members of the industry to come together for fellowship and networking. As part of Singapore's Golden Jubilee celebration, the 2015 GI Day focused on the theme of family, with 500 people spending the day with their families on a trip to the newly opened Lee Kong Chian Natural History Museum.

Participants were treated to guided tours, activities and entertainment on Singapore and Southeast Asia's biodiversity. And as part of its corporate social responsibility programme, GIA invited underprivileged children of Beyond Social Service and their families to join in the fun.

To develop camaraderie with marine insurance professionals, GIA and the Singapore Maritime Foundation organised the 5th Marine Insurance & Maritime Networking Event for ship financiers, ship owners, classification societies, shipbrokers and maritime lawyers. The event fostered friendship and bettered the working relationship between marine insurance and maritime professionals across different specialisations.

The year would not be complete without the GIA Appreciation Night. In 2015, GIA thanked the industry for its support of the Association's various programmes at the Wine Company@Sentosa Boardwalk. General insurance professionals, including GIA members, stakeholders, GIP mentors and past and present GIP interns partook of good food and drinks while being serenaded by great music and treated to a fireworks show.

GROWING OUR RANKS

In a sign of global insurance players' confidence in the Singapore general insurance market, Berkshire Hathaway Specialty Insurance Company has joined GIA as its newest and 35th addition to its network of members.



GENERAL INSURANCE ASSOCIATION OF SINGAPORE

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